

Personal Cyber Hygiene Improvement Plan

Conducted by : Khadijah Abdullahi

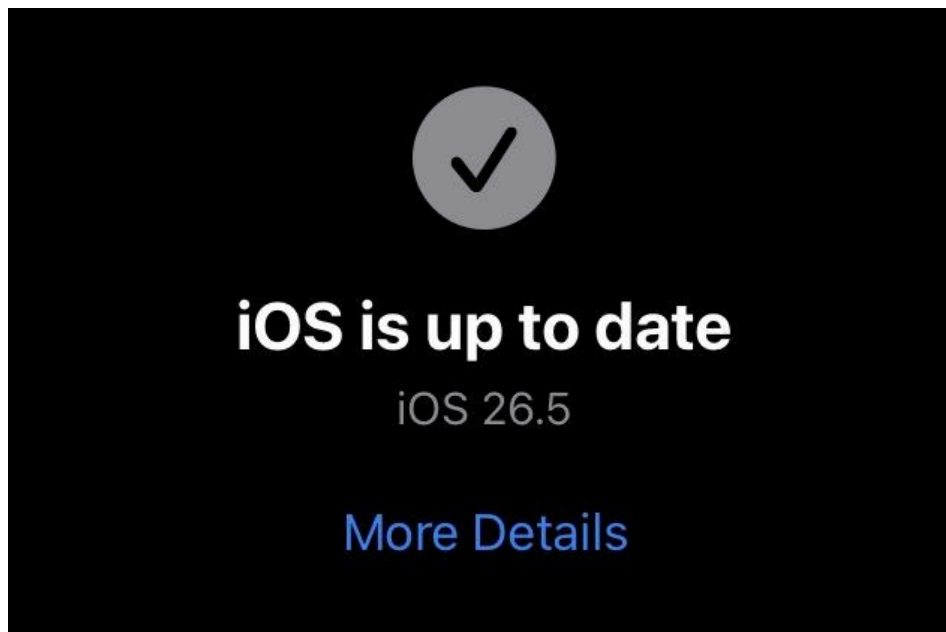
Date : 6th June, 2026

Time :11:45 am

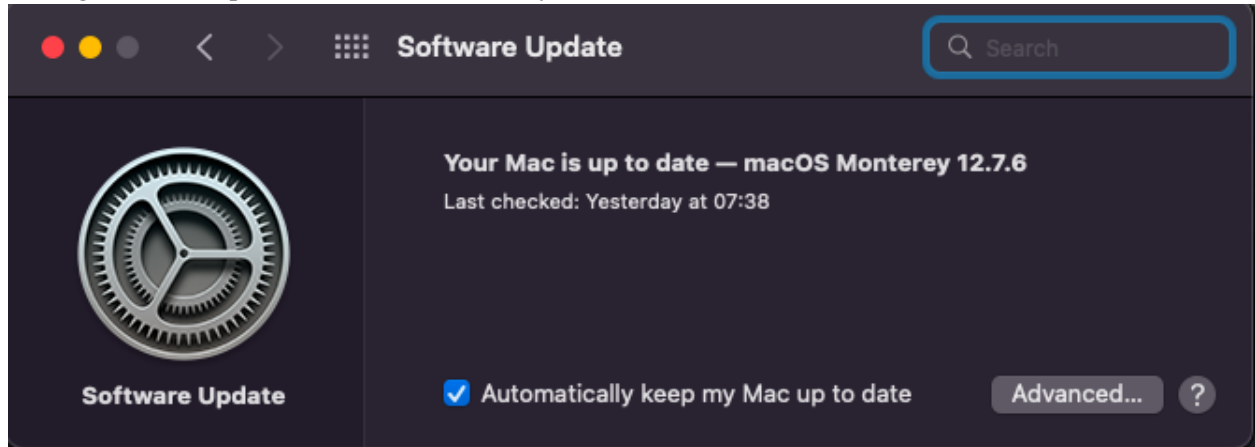
Device inventory

- Iphone11
- Macbook Air early 2015
- MTN router

Iphone11 iOS was on 26.4 and doing this security check helped me to confirm that my automatic update allowed the 26.5 to successfully update and install itself.

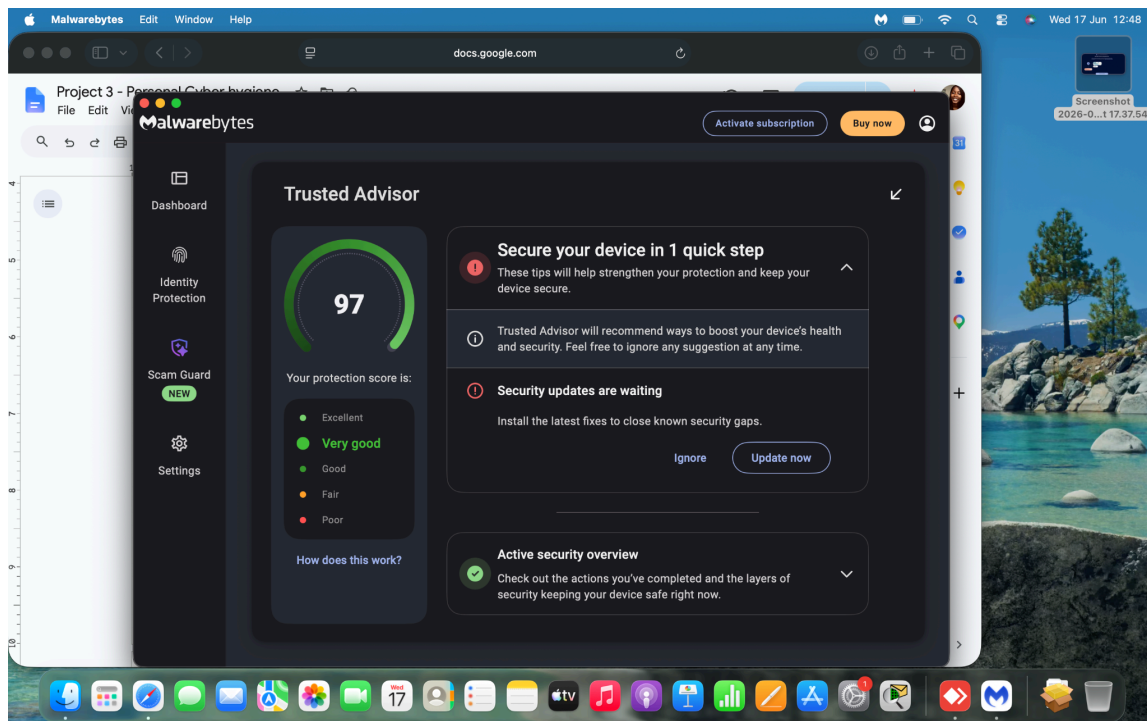


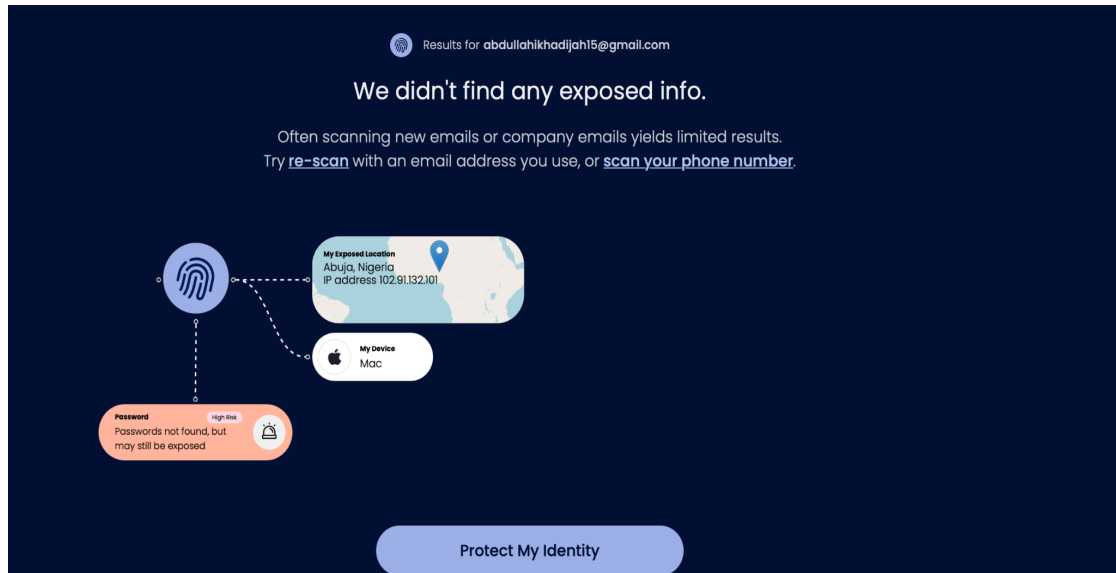
My Macbook laptop has not been updated since i bought it. So being that it is a very old laptop I only could get the iOS updated to macOS Monterey 12.7.6.



In the meantime, I use my sister's Macbook Pro M1 to study ethical hacking and do some work.

I came across malwarebytes, a cybersecurity software used to carry out scans on devices e.g. laptop and phone. Here is the first result of my scan





MTN Home router

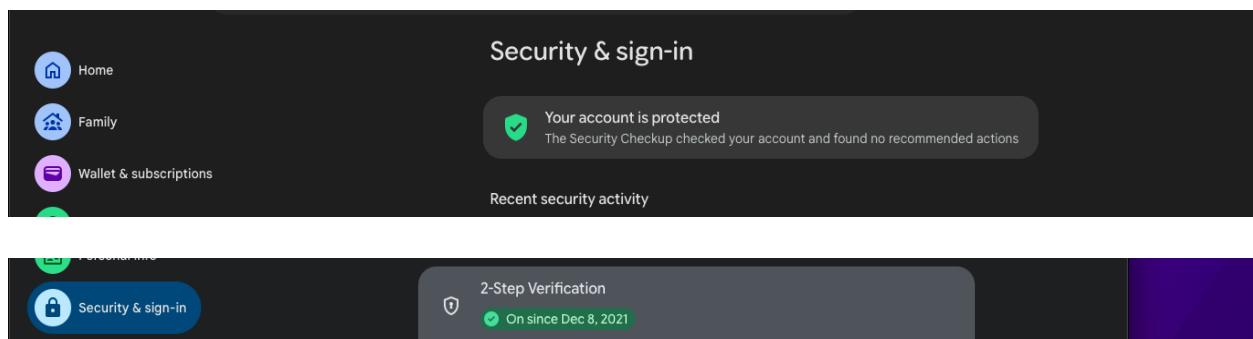
I just bought the router last week so the first thing I did was to change the default name and password. I also occasionally login to the admin dashboard to see what devices are connected to the router. The software version is okay and I will update it as soon as i can.

Hardware Version	V9.0
Software Version	V9.0.11P5N17
Boot Version	V9.0.11P10N6

Results from reviewing the below

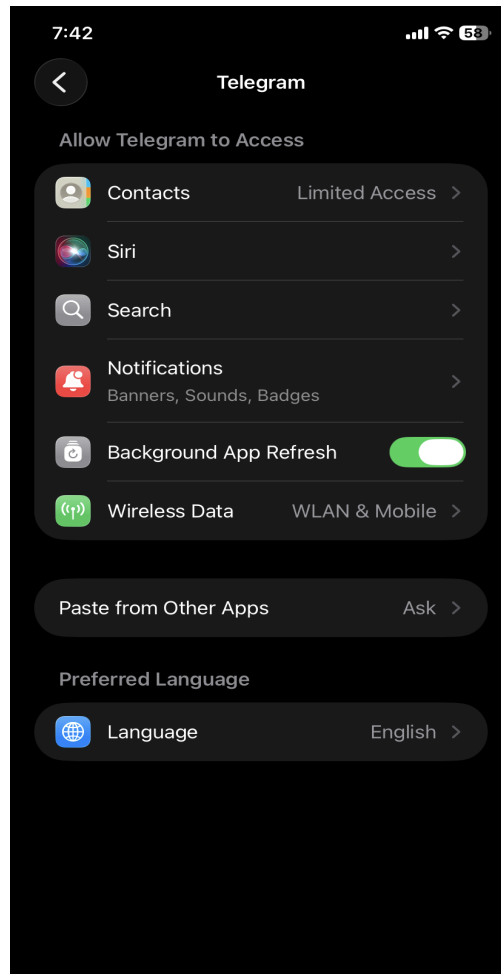
- Primary email - Gmail account
- Financial account - United Bank of Nigeria

My email account is protected. I have a strong password combination and it is not a password i'm using on another account.

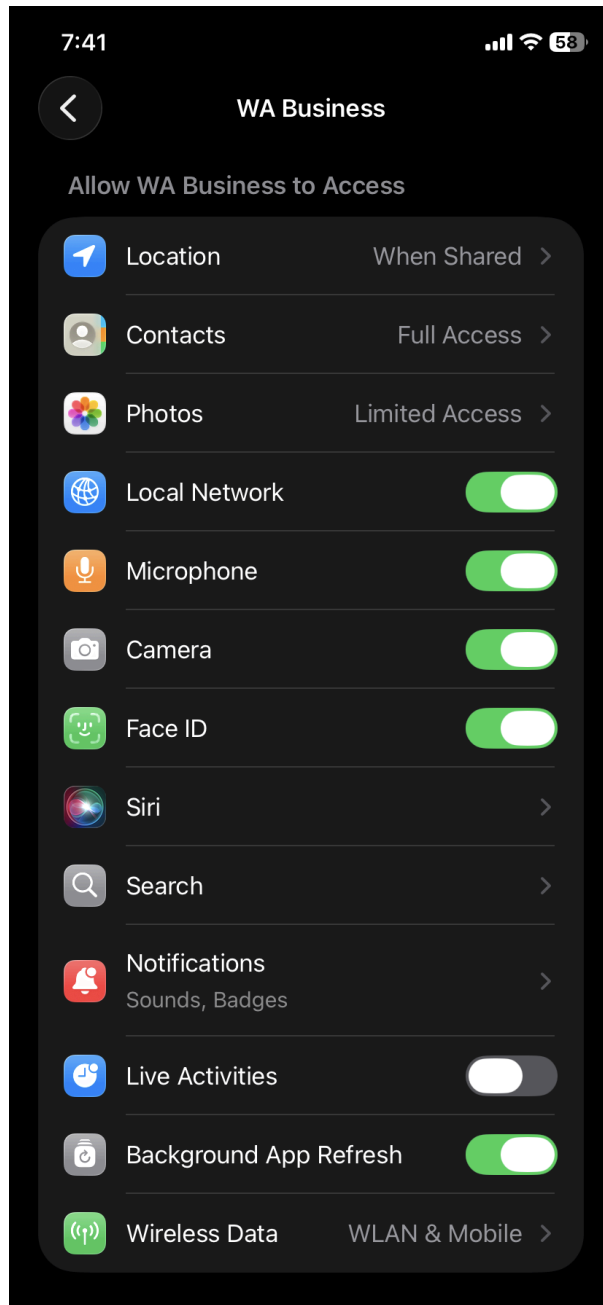


Social media platforms and third party applications

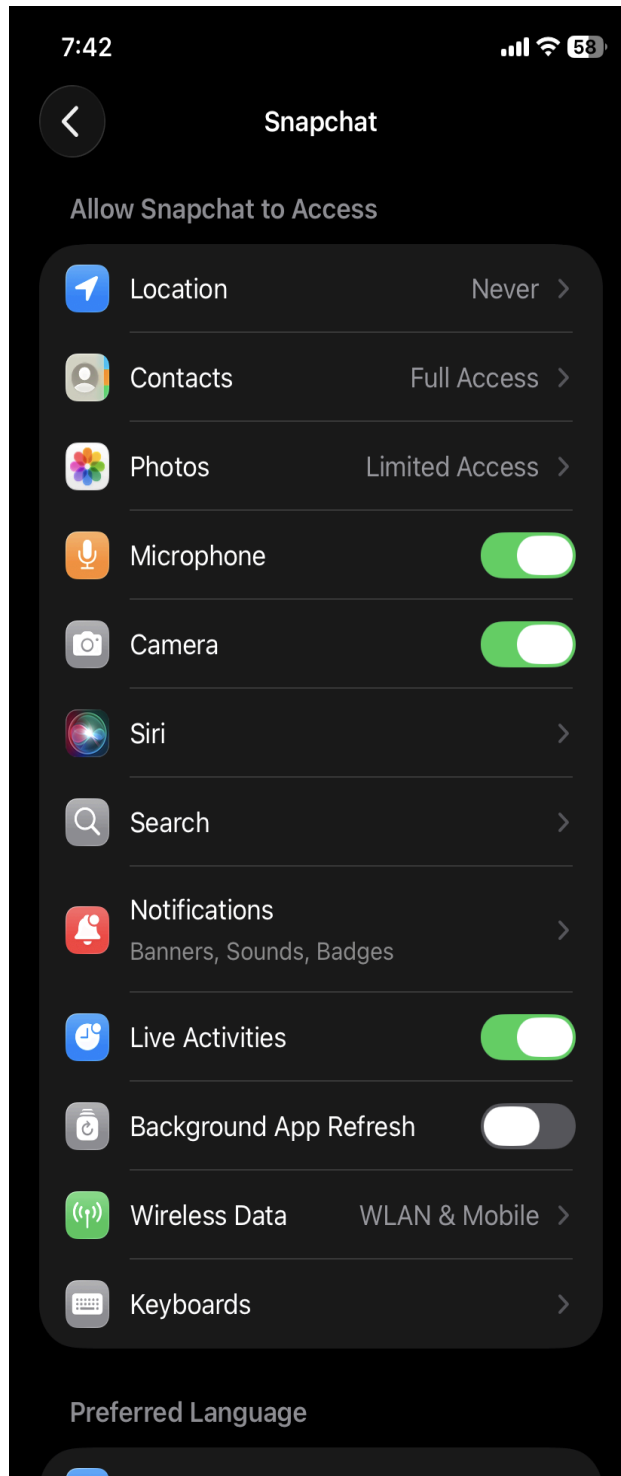
Snapchat, Whatsapp, Telegram, Gaplite banking app all have strict restrictions set by me. I don't let them have access to my pictures, or location. Below are screenshots showing it.



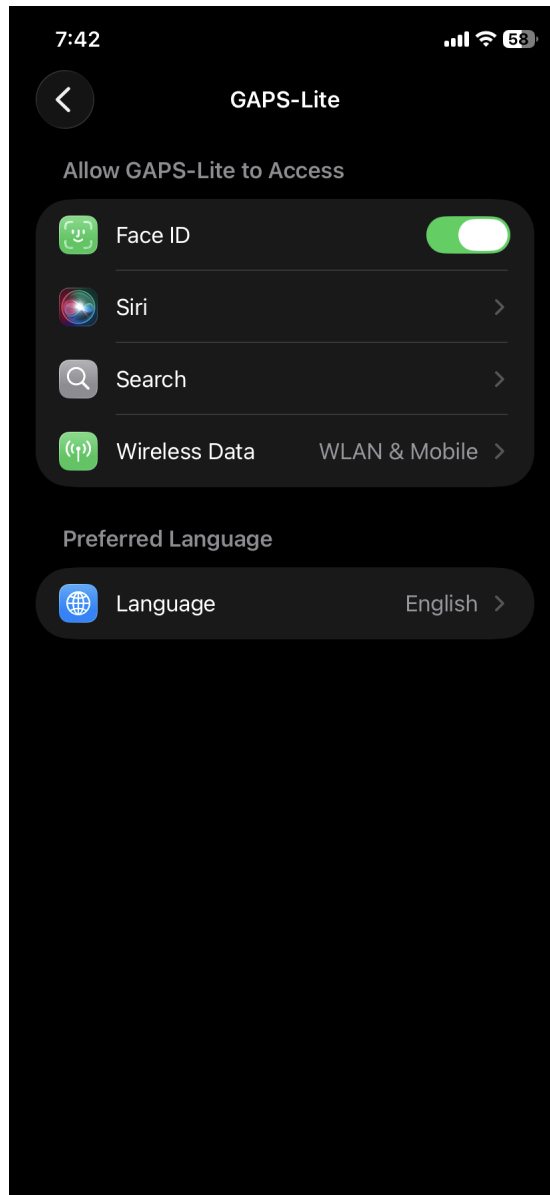
Telegram settings shown



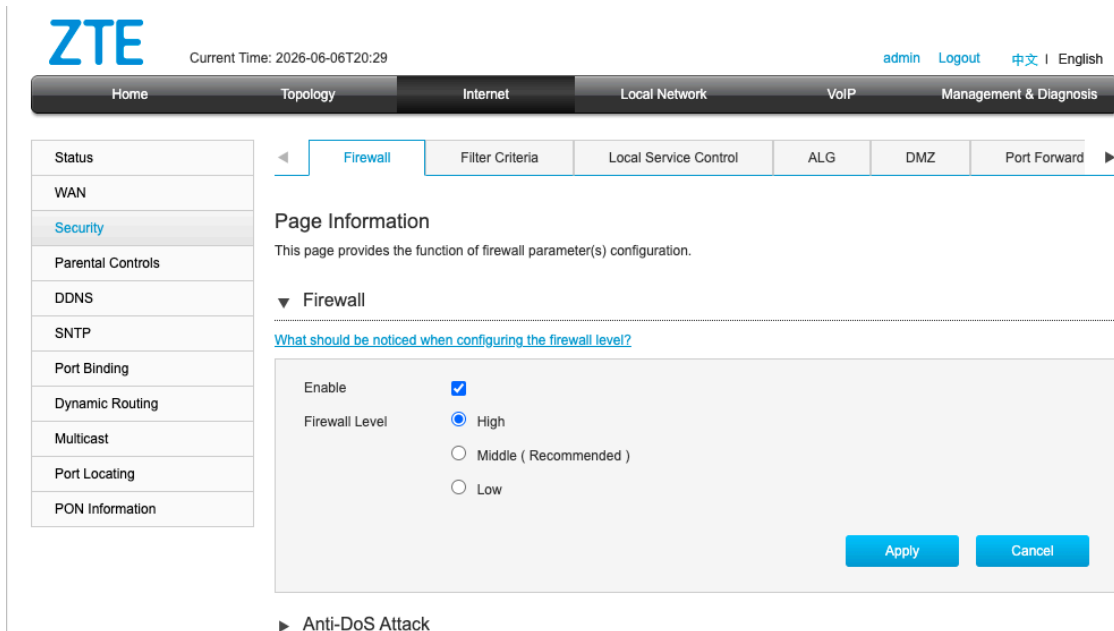
Whatsapp has a strict setting i enabled as seen above.



Snapchat settings were modified by me as seen above.



My banking app has a faceidentification feature enabled and i take a physical token device for my transactions.



My home router has a changed default username and password. I also enabled the firewall as shown in the picture.

Risk Assement

The following table categorizes key vulnerabilities based on potential impact (High: major data/financial loss or identity theft; Medium: limited exposure; Low: inconvenience) and likelihood (High: common attack vector; Medium: possible; Low: rare given current practices).

Vulnerabilty/ Area	Impact	Likelihood	Risk Level	Rationale
Outdated Macbook	High	High	High	Approaching end of life; may soon loose security patches
Incomplete/ full MFA on all accounts	High	Medium	High	Single point of failure if password is compromised
Limited data encryption	High	Medium	High	Theft or unauthorized access could expose sensitive files
Router firmware updates	Medium	Medium	Medium	New device but firmware needs timely updates
Social media privacy settings	Medium	Low	Low	Already strengthened; ongoing monitoring needed
Phishing awareness	Low	Low	Low	Strong verification habit already in place

Cyber hygiene is essential in preventing cyber threats and ensuring digital security. The personal audit I carried out revealed **weaknesses** in password security and multi-factor authentication (MFA) usage, device protection, software updates, data encryption, social media privacy, but strengths in phishing awareness because I don't click on links that are not from trusted parties and I confirm documents source before downloading.

This plan outlines **actionable steps that** will bring improvement and methods to **track effectiveness**.

Current data backup procedures

At this point I only have an external drive and 2 flash drives that i use. My documents are not encrypted yet and I intend on trying out Veracrypt. Some of my documents are also saved on google drive. The folders have not been tampered with and after adding an extra layer of security I'm confident that it would be better.

Security improvement plan

1. Strengthening Device Security

- My router has an inbuilt hardware and software firewall which is enabled from the admin account.

Tracking Effectiveness:

- Conduct **weekly security scans** to identify vulnerabilities in my network and devices.
- Monitor **firewall logs** for any suspicious activity.

2. Ensuring Regular Software & Device Updates

- I'll establish a **biweekly reminder** for update checks.

Tracking Effectiveness:

- I'll track **update history** to ensure all software remains current.
- I'll monitor **device performance** post-updates for improvements.

3. Enhancing Social Media Privacy & Online Behavior

- **Review and adjust privacy settings** on all my social media accounts.
- **Limit public sharing** of personal information to reduce exposure. This exercise has made me take down a few posts, adjusted my profile bio and enabled 2 factor authentication on all my accounts.

Tracking Effectiveness:

- Perform a **monthly privacy audit** to verify settings.
- Check for **unauthorized third-party access** and revoke unnecessary permissions.

4. Improving Phishing Awareness & Email Security

- Use **trusted verification tools** like VirusTotal for suspicious emails, documents and urls.
- Configure **advanced spam filtering** and enable MFA for sensitive accounts. By frequently going through my spam folder and selecting valid senders I'm gradually training google to spot spam emails earlier.

Tracking Effectiveness:

- Document instances of **phishing attempts identified and avoided**. For example i just read a phishing email sent to me by someone posing to be a talent manager at the coca cola company. I immediately used virus total to scan and then I reported the message.
- Review **email security logs** to assess phishing defense effectiveness.

5. Establishing Data Backup & Encryption Practices

- **Set up automatic cloud backups** using Google Drive or external storage. I have an 1TB external drive that has my important files.
- **Implement encryption tools** (e.g., VeraCrypt) to protect sensitive files

Tracking Effectiveness:

- Conduct **monthly backup integrity checks** to ensure recoverability.
- Periodically **test encrypted file accessibility** for security verification.

Takeaways for Cyber Hygiene Improvement

By implementing **multi-layered security measures**, regularly **auditing privacy settings**, and enhancing **phishing detection**, cybersecurity hygiene will **significantly improve** and be **trackable** over time.

Monitor & Review

Tracking progress is essential to ensuring **consistent cybersecurity improvements**. Here's how each area will be **monitored and reviewed** over time:

- **Device Security:** Conduct **weekly antivirus scans** and review **firewall logs** for unusual activity.
- **Software Updates:** Maintain a **biweekly update checklist** and track system performance changes.
- **Social Media Privacy:** Perform a **monthly privacy review**, checking settings and permissions.
- **Phishing Awareness:** Log **phishing attempts identified and avoided**, analyzing patterns to enhance detection.
- **Data Backup & Encryption:** Conduct **integrity checks** every month, ensuring data is backed up and encrypted correctly.

End-of-Life (EOL) Devices

The MacBook Air (Early 2015) is nearing or at End-of-Life status for Apple security updates. MacOS Monterey 12.7.6 is the final supported version. Risks include:

- No future security patches for new vulnerabilities.

- Increased exposure to malware and exploits.

Action Plan for EOL Device:

- Migrate critical work and sensitive data to a newer device (e.g., sister's M1 MacBook Pro when possible or plan for a future purchase/upgrade).
- Use the 2015 MacBook only for low-risk, offline, or non-sensitive tasks.
- Enable full-disk encryption (FileVault) if not already active.
- Monitor Apple's security update announcements closely.
- Consider decommissioning or isolating the device once a suitable replacement is available.